Abdullah Al Zahid

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Talent Acquisition
Capital Projects Group, Third Party Coordination - Agreements
Metrolinx, 20 Bay Street, Toronto, ON

Re: Senior Advisor, Agreements

Dear Hiring Manager,

I would like to apply for one of the two Senior Advisor, Agreements positions with the Third Party Coordination team in the Capital Projects Group. I am an Assistant Planner in Transportation Planning at the City of Toronto, and before that I was a Transportation Planner at Metrolinx in GO rail service design, so I know both sides of the table these agreements are negotiated across.

At the City I review development applications and the transportation studies filed with them against City standards and Official Plan policy, and recommend conditions where something is missing. I advise applicants and staff on transportation planning and related regulations, and I coordinate with divisions, consultants, applicants and outside agencies whose priorities conflict, working issues through to a position everyone can act on. That has taught me which parts of a municipality a request touches and how its conditions get set.

At Metrolinx I ran OpenTrack simulations of GO rail services and assessed what temporary and permanent slow orders, the kind of restriction construction on an operating railway imposes, would do to service. I also set up a command line workflow that pre-simulated slow orders in batches, cutting turnaround on scenario requests from days to hours, and built the Crew Variance Tool, a Python application that read large JSON operations files and summarised speed profiles and run-time variance across subdivisions.

I should be straightforward about the gaps. I have not negotiated or drafted agreements, and I have not worked on P3 financing or procurement. I would also be learning the legislative side of agreements work, including the Environmental Assessment Act and the Occupational Health and Safety Act. I am applying because the coordination with municipalities at the centre of the role is work I do every day.

Thank you for considering my application.

Sincerely,

Abdullah Al Zahid

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